- Highly distributed storage systems able to scale storage and I/O capacity without limits: Amazon S3, Azure Blob Storage, Google Cloud Storage
- A pay-as-you-go pricing model

But what are the differences between the cloud providers?

AWS is the market leader in cloud computing, offering an extensive product portfolio. Although AWS has expanded into the enterprise sector during recent years, it is still obvious that AWS started with services to solve internet-scale problems. Overall, AWS is building great services based on innovative, mostly open source, technologies. AWS offers complicated but rock-solid ways to restrict access to your cloud infrastructure.

Microsoft Azure provides Microsoft's technology stack in the cloud, recently expanding into web-centric and open source technologies as well. It seems like Microsoft is putting a lot of effort into catching up with Amazon's market share in cloud computing.

The Google Cloud Platform (GCP) is focused on developers looking to build sophisticated distributed systems. Google combines their worldwide infrastructure to offer scalable and fault-tolerant services (such as Google Cloud Load Balancing). The GCP seems more focused on cloud-native applications than on migrating your locally hosted applications to the cloud, in our opinion.

There are no shortcuts to making an informed decision about which cloud provider to choose. Each use case and project is different—the devil is in the details. Also don't forget where you are coming from. (Are you using Microsoft technology heavily? Do you have a big team consisting of system administrators or are you a developer-centric